

LDT4SSC Project Methodology

Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)

Data Governance Workshop

Workshop: Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance: Deep dive into legal and contractual requirements

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Authors: Cerema



Document History

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May 2026	v1	Marine Le Gall, Laura Riou, Sophie Houzet	First version adapted from the CAPACities program.

Workshop Overview

Title	Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance: Deep dive into legal and contractual requirements
Methodological step	Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)
Duration	1 hour and 30 mins to 2 hours
Number of Facilitators	1 for each group of 4 to 5 people
Equipment Needed	• One big sheet of paper (1m/2m) or a large (digital) whiteboard • A4 sheets • Pens and markers of several colors • Sticky notes
Expected outcomes	• A list of the projects' legal requirements, challenges and issues. • An action plan for tackling these issues, requirements and challenges. • A summary note produced after the workshop, outlining key findings and next steps.

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1. Context and objectives

The **Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance** workshop is part of the **VALIDATE step (specification)** which bridges the gap between the project's initial idea and its practical implementation. It translates the use cases into **technical and functional requirements**, while accounting for real-world constraints such as interoperability, data, architecture, security, and putting the user's needs at the center.

More information on the objectives, prerequisites and stakeholders to involve in the EXPLORE step can be found on the LDT4SSC Knowledge Hub¹.

The workshop is designed to achieve the following objectives:

- Pinpoint the specific **legal and contractual requirements** for data governance.
- Refine the legal framework to **mitigate risks and ensure compliance**.
- Define **concrete, actionable courses of action**, translating identified needs into practical steps.
- **Categorise each requirement** based on feasibility to create a **roadmap** for improving data management

2. Workshop

2.1. Workshop phases overview

<i>Time spent</i>	<i>Phase</i>	<i>Description</i>
15 mins	0. Framing	Participants are reminded of the chosen use case and the objectives of the project in order to anchor the reflection in a concrete context.
20 mins	1. Identifying Legal Requirements	Participants list their legal & regulatory requirements on post-it notes to identify missing contractual clauses, internal processes to be developed, etc.
30 mins	2. Developing a Structured Action Sheet	For each issue identified, participants complete an action sheet.
20 mins	3. Defining Next Phases	For each issue, participants identify possible next phases.
10 mins	4. Synthesising Outcomes and Wrapping Up	Each group presents its use case, the problems identified and the proposed solutions.

¹ https://knowledgehub.ldt4ssc.eu/resources_content/methodology/

2.2. Workshop step by step guide

Phase 0: Framing and Icebreaker (recommended allocated time: 15 mins)

The facilitator orients the participants **towards the selected use case** and the overarching project objectives. They list all **relevant project factors** such as: goals, stakeholders, budget. This initial phase ensures that the subsequent discussions remain grounded in a **clear and concrete context**. It also serves to **align all stakeholders** on the purpose, scope, and expected outcomes of the workshop, fostering a shared understanding before diving into deeper phases.

The facilitator also **organises an icebreaker** designed to foster mental and creative engagement by encouraging participants to adopt a playful, and open mindset. This initial interactive, game-like activity, stimulates imaginative thinking, reduces initial social tension, and prepares participants to engage fully in subsequent workshop phases.

Phase 1: Identifying Legal Requirements (recommended allocated time: 20 mins)

The activity begins by **hanging a large sheet of paper on the wall or using a digital paperboard** as a shared workspace for the group. Participants are then given **ten minutes to individually write down the data related legal and regulatory requirements** and challenges on post-it notes. Each note must focus on **one specific item**. These challenges might include issues such as **missing contractual clauses, underdeveloped internal processes, data fragmentation problems, or areas needing regulatory clarification**.

Once the individual brainstorming phase is complete, the group moves onto a **collaborative pooling phase**. All post-it notes are **collected and organised on the shared workspace**, where **similar or related issues are grouped together**. This process helps **highlight patterns, recurring themes, and priorities**, enabling the team to **identify and focus on the most critical or widespread legal challenges** that will be addressed in the subsequent phases of the workshop. This approach ensures that the discussion is **grounded in real, actionable insights** and fosters a **shared understanding** of the legal landscape.

To go further, the facilitator can leverage the [Data Space Support Center's "trigger" methodology](#) to identify other legal requirements specific to the LDTs' use-case, data and participants.

Phase 2: Developing a Structured Action Sheet (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

In this phase, participants will dedicate time to **developing a structured action sheet for each of the key legal issues, challenges and requirements** identified in the previous phase. Each action sheet is divided into **four clear sections** to ensure a comprehensive approach:

Section	Description
1. Description of the Current legal challenge	Participants will clearly define the challenge outlining its scope and impact on the project (what is the issue ?).
2. Proposed Solution	The group will brainstorm and articulate how the issue can be resolved , focusing on practical and actionable steps (how to resolve it?).
3. Stakeholders Involved	Participants will identify who needs to be engaged to address the issue, including internal teams, external partners, or regulatory bodies (with whom?).
4. Means or Tools Required	The group will specify what resources, tools, or processes are necessary to implement the proposed solution effectively (with what means?).

Phase 3: Defining Next Steps (recommended allocated time: 20 mins)

In this phase, participants allocate **twenty minutes to organise and prioritise the actionable next steps** for each identified issue:

1. First, participants **identify actions that can be addressed within the current project scope**, ensuring that progress can be made immediately where feasible. This phase focuses on **prioritising tasks that require minimal additional resources or approvals**.
2. Next, the group **determines which issues require the involvement of legal experts** to resolve complex or high-stakes matters. This ensures that **specialised legal support** is allocated where needed, providing a robust foundation for addressing intricate regulatory or compliance challenges.

These first actions can be added to the legal framework from the 2.2.4. *Complementing your Data Governance Roadmap with a Legal Framework: From Mapping Legal Phases to Action* workshop and the Data-Governance Roadmap in its legal section.

3. Participants then **pinpoint opportunities for collaboration with external stakeholders**, including **local authority associations, professional federations, or**

partner organizations. By leveraging collective expertise and resources, shared challenges can be **addressed more effectively through coordinated efforts.**

4. Finally, the group **highlights issues requiring formal reporting to State authorities**, such as **proposed legislative changes or requests for regulatory adjustments.** This ensures that higher-level policies are **aligned with project needs** and that necessary approvals or modifications are sought in a timely manner.

This structured approach guarantees that **every issue is assigned a practical and actionable path forward**, facilitating **efficient progress and accountability** in the project's next phases.

Phase 4: Synthetising Outcomes and Wrapping Up (recommended allocated time: 10 mins)

To conclude the workshop, participants engage in a **collective feedback session**, during which they **review the selected issues and their corresponding action sheets.** This discussion provides an opportunity for the group to **reflect on the relevance and completeness of the proposed solutions**, ensuring that all perspectives and considerations have been thoroughly addressed.

The session also **highlights the gaps between currently available resources and those still missing**, clarifying where **additional support, tools, or interventions** are required to fully address the identified challenges.

Finally, the group **collectively validates the next phases / steps**, confirming which actions will be **prioritized within the project** and which will require **collaboration with external partners.** This shared agreement ensures **alignment and commitment** among all participants, enabling the project to move forward effectively and with a clear, unified direction.

2.3. Recommendations for Workshop facilitation

To ensure the workshop's effectiveness, facilitators are advised to adopt the following approaches:

Prepare the Space and Materials

The workshop space should be **arranged with ample wall space** to accommodate large sheets of paper, post-it notes, and action sheets, ensuring that all materials are **easily visible and accessible** to every participant. Clear, step-by-step instructions and examples for each phase, such as how to complete post-it notes and action sheets, must be provided in advance to **minimise confusion** and **keep the workshop progressing smoothly** without unnecessary interruptions.

Create an Inclusive and Engaged Atmosphere

The session should commence with a **brief icebreaker activity** to foster participation and establish a **collaborative and engaging tone** from the outset. It is crucial to **emphasise the value of all contributions**, particularly during individual brainstorming, while **actively encouraging quieter participants** to share their ideas. Using a timer for each activity will

help **maintain momentum**, ensuring discussions remain **focused and dynamic** throughout the workshop.

Guide the Brainstorming and Pooling Phases

Facilitators must **clearly define the scope of issues** to be addressed, whether legal, contractual, or organisational, to ensure discussions remain **relevant and targeted**. Participants should be encouraged to **write specific, single-issue notes** on sticky notes, each describing a distinct problem or idea. During the pooling phase, facilitators should **ask participants to explain their notes**, helping the group **identify themes, recurring challenges, or overlaps**, while allowing the discussion to be **participant-led** rather than facilitator-dominated.

Support the Action Sheet Phase

Facilitators should **circulate among participants** to clarify any questions and ensure everyone understands how to complete the action sheets accurately. A **consistent visual coding system**, such as using  for existing resources and  for gaps, will help the group **quickly identify priorities** and areas requiring attention. Participants should be prompted to consider **feasible solutions, responsible stakeholders, and necessary resources** for each issue, ensuring that proposed actions are **practical and implementable**.

Facilitate the Next Phases / Steps Discussion

Different colours or markers should be used to **distinguish between actions** requiring internal handling, state intervention, collaborative efforts, or legal support. Facilitators should guide prioritisation by asking focused questions, such as, **"Which actions will deliver the most immediate impact?"** or **"What can realistically be achieved within the next three months?"** Documenting decisions in **real time** on a flip chart or digital tool ensures **transparency and collective ownership** of the agreed-upon next steps.

Manage Time and Energy

Adherence to the **allocated timeline for each phase** is essential to ensure all objectives are met without rushing or omitting critical discussions. Should conversations extend beyond the planned duration, facilitators should **gently redirect the group** to maintain progress. For workshops exceeding 90 minutes, **short breaks** should be incorporated to **sustain energy and focus**. Summarising key points after each phase **reinforces progress** and keeps participants **aligned and motivated**.

Close with Clarity and Commitment

The workshop should conclude with a **comprehensive recap** of the outcomes, including the **selected issues, completed action sheets, identified gaps, and next steps**, ensuring that all participants **understand their roles and responsibilities**. Follow-up tasks, such as drafting memos or contacting partners, should be **assigned with clear deadlines** to maintain momentum. Ending on a **positive note**, with gratitude for participants' contributions and an emphasis on the **collective value of the work**, reinforces a sense of **achievement and shared purpose**.

Follow Up After the Workshop

Promptly after the session, the **documented outcomes**, including photographs of sheets, action plans, and next steps, should be **shared with all participants and stakeholders**. Scheduling a **follow-up meeting** to review progress on agreed actions and address any

emerging challenges will **sustain accountability** and ensure that the workshop's momentum translates into **tangible results**.

By following these recommendations, facilitators can create a dynamic, inclusive, and results-oriented workshop that not only clarifies stakeholder needs and solutions but also empowers participants to drive meaningful change within their organisations.

3. Next Steps

The following workshops for the VALIDATE step are:

- *2.3 Inventorying your LDT Project Data: Unlocking Interoperability, Listing and committing to share data among partners*
- *2.4 Identifying Levers, Obstacles and Objectives for Interoperability: From Awareness to Actionable Strategies for LDT Projects*
- *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play: A Transversal Tool to Address and Overcome Data Governance Challenges*

NB: The *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play* workshop is a workshop aimed at unwrapping bottlenecks via the usage of Legos, so it can be paired with any and all workshops in the VALIDATE step.

Next Methodology steps:

- *Done: Complete the EXPLORE workshops*
- *Ongoing: Complete the VALIDATE workshops*
- *Complete the DEFINE workshops*
- *Complete the IMPLEMENT workshops*

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